Decision Record DR-2026-016: Delta Lake

Document control	
Document ID	DR-2026-016
Document type	Decision Record
Date	2026-06-16
Status	Accepted
Meeting	TRBM-2026-06-16
Review IDs	TRB-2026-016
Feature keys	Delta Lake@Storage & Formats
Classification	Internal – Synthetic Sample

> Acme Health Plan is fictional. This is a synthetic sample document for the Databricks Feature Tracker.

Status: Approved · **Approved scope:** PHI · **Decided at:** TRBM-2026-06-16
Review: TRB-2026-016 · **Feature:** `Delta Lake@Storage & Formats` · **Databricks phase at decision:** GA

Context

Enterprise Data Platform designated Delta as the default table format for all PHI workloads. TRB reviewed ACID guarantees, time-travel retention, and interoperability.

Decision

Delta Lake is approved as the default table format. All new tables use Delta unless approved for Iceberg. Time-travel and VACUUM retention are set per table to meet the records-retention policy.

Risks considered

- Time-travel retention increases storage cost

- Format lock-in vs. open formats
- Upgrade complexity for large tables

Mitigations relied on

- VACUUM policy: 180-day retention for PHI, 30 days for analytics
- Iceberg interoperability via UniForm
- Delta version checks automated in CI/CD

Control mappings

- HIPAA-Security-Rule 164.312(b) (Audit controls): Satisfied
- NIST-800-53-R5 SC-7 (Boundary Protection): Satisfied
- HITRUST-CSF 09.a (System Development and Maintenance): Satisfied

Re-review

Trigger: Annual re-review · Next review: 2027-06-16